

AoE2 Tournament Agent

Version 5 — Platform Organiser Guide
Age of Empires II: Definitive Edition

Everything you need to run tournaments for multiple Discord communities from one platform.

Installation · Hosting · Creating Tournaments · Managing Communities · Revenue Tracking

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1. What Is This App & How You Make Money

The **AoE2 Tournament Agent** is a single web application that hosts unlimited AoE2 community tournaments simultaneously. Each community gets their own isolated URL, admin panel, player roster, and bracket system — all powered by one app that you control.

Revenue model — PayPal-based, fully tracked:

Fee Type		Who Gets It	Amount	How It's Paid
Platform Admin Fee		You	You set it per tournament (e.g. \$5 per player)	Player pays via PayPal directly to your email
Prize Pool Fee		Discord host	Host sets it (e.g. \$10 per player)	Player pays via PayPal directly to host's email

Each player pays **two separate PayPal payments** — one to you, one to the tournament host. The app generates pre-filled PayPal links with the amount and a tracking note containing the player's email, the tournament name, and their Discord tag, so every payment is easy to match to a player.

Example with 5 communities, 80 players each, \$5 admin fee:

$5 \times 80 \times \$5 = \text{\$2,000}$ in admin fees per tournament season — plus whatever you charge for setup and hosting.

Placement games are always free. Only tournament bracket entry costs the player fee. This keeps the barrier to entry low and encourages more registrations.

Privacy by design: Your admin fee profit is visible only to you, behind your platform master password. Tournament admins and players never see your earnings — they only see the prize pool total, which is everyone's business since it funds the prizes.

2. Requirements

- 1 **Node.js** — free from nodejs.org. Install once, never touch again.
- 2 **Any modern browser** — Chrome or Edge work best.
- 3 **The app file** — aoe2-tournament.jsx (in your zip).
- 4 **For hosting online** — a free Railway.app or Render.com account (see Section 5).

Recommended: Host online so communities access their URL from anywhere without you keeping your PC running.

3. Installation on Windows 11

Step A — Install Node.js

- 1 Go to <https://nodejs.org> in your browser.
- 2 Click the big green **LTS** button to download.
- 3 Double-click the downloaded file. Click Next through every screen. Click Finish.

Step B — Set up the project folder

Create a folder, for example:

```
C:\Users\YourName\Documents\aoe2-agent
```

Put **aoe2-tournament.jsx** inside it.

Step C — Open Terminal

Press Windows key, type Terminal, press Enter. Then navigate to your folder:

```
cd C:\Users\YourName\Documents\aoe2-agent
```

Step D — Create the React project

```
npm create vite@latest . -- --template react
```

When prompted: type **y** → select **React** → select **JavaScript**. Then:

```
npm install
```

Step E — Connect your app file

- 1 Copy **aoe2-tournament.jsx** into the **src** subfolder.
- 2 Open **src/App.jsx** in Notepad. Delete everything inside. Paste exactly:

```
import TournamentApp from './aoe2-tournament' export default function  
App(){ return }
```

Save and close Notepad.

4. Running the App Locally

- 1 Open Terminal and navigate to your folder.
- 2 Type: **npm run dev** and press Enter.
- 3 Open your browser and go to: **http://localhost:5173**
- 4 Leave the Terminal window open while you use the app.
- 5 To stop the app: click in Terminal and press **Ctrl + C**.

URL structure when running locally: <http://localhost:5173/> — Landing page (all tournaments) <http://localhost:5173/#/admin> — Your platform admin dashboard <http://localhost:5173/#/t/NA-KINGS> — Example tournament URL

5. Hosting Online (Recommended)

Online hosting means communities access their tournament URL 24/7 from any device, anywhere in the world — without you keeping your PC on.

How to deploy on Railway.app (free tier):

- 1 Create a free account at <https://railway.app>.
- 2 Create a free account at <https://github.com>.
- 3 On GitHub: click the **+** button → New repository → name it **aoe2-agent** → Create.
- 4 Upload all your project files to the repository (drag and drop in the browser).
- 5 Back in Railway: click **New Project** → **Deploy from GitHub repo** → select aoe2-agent.
- 6 Railway detects it's a Vite/React project. Add a start command: **npx serve dist**
- 7 In Build settings, set build command: **npm run build**
- 8 Click **Deploy**. In about 2 minutes, Railway gives you a URL like:
<https://aoe2-agent-production-abc.railway.app>
- 9 Share this base URL with communities. Their tournament is at:
baseURL/#!/t/THEIR-CODE

Important after deploying: Log into your platform admin at **yourURL/#!/admin** and change the master password from 'Wireless' to something secure.

Host	Free Tier	Notes
Railway.app	\$5 credit/month	Easiest setup — recommended
Render.com	Free (sleeps after inactivity)	Good for testing
Netlify	Free	Static sites only — needs extra config

6. Your Platform Admin Dashboard (/#/admin)

Go to **yourURL/#/admin** and enter your master password (default: **Wireless**).

Tab	What It Shows
Dashboard	Total tournaments, total players, total admin fees collected, open disputes
Tournaments	All tournaments with their URLs, admin passwords, player counts, and fee summaries. Delete tournaments here.
Fees	Complete revenue breakdown — every admin fee and prize fee collected across all communities
Settings	Change master password, export full platform backup, restore backup
Log	Platform-level activity: tournaments created, deleted, major events

The Fees tab is your revenue dashboard. It shows total admin fees across all tournaments — your complete income picture.

7. Creating a Tournament for a Community

1 Log into Platform Admin at **yourURL/#/admin**.

2 Click the **+ New Tournament** button.

3 Fill in the form:

Field	What to Enter	Example
Tournament Code	Short URL-friendly ID. Letters, numbers, hyphens only. No spaces.	NA-KINGS
Tournament Name	The full name shown on the tournament home page.	North America Kings
Host / Server Name	The Discord server or community name.	NA AoE2 Community
Admin Password	Password the server host uses to access their admin panel.	(leave blank for 'changeme')

1 Click **Create Tournament**.

2 Set the **Platform Admin Fee (\$ per player)** — this is your cut. Only you can set or change this.

3 The tournament URL is instantly shown: **yourURL/#/t/NA-KINGS**

4 Copy the URL — you'll send this to the community.

Tell every host: Change your admin password immediately after first login. Go to Admin (in their tournament nav) → Passwords → Change Admin Password.

8. Handing Off to a Discord Server Host

After creating the tournament, send the host:

Item	What to Send	Example
Tournament URL	Their unique tournament address	https://yourapp.railway.app/#/t/NA-KI-NGS
Admin Password	The password you set (or 'changeme' if left blank)	changeme (tell them to change it!)
How to access admin	Click Admin in their tournament nav	Enter their password to unlock
Admin fee amount	How much per player goes to you (read-only for them)	\$5 per player

What the host does next:

- 1 Open their tournament URL and click Admin.
- 2 Enter their password and go to Season settings.
- 3 Set the season name and prize fee amount (their cut, distributed to winners).
- 4 **Add their PayPal email** in Season settings — this is required before they can launch a paid bracket. Players send the prize fee here.
- 5 Configure divisions (tiers) and prize splits (% for 1st/2nd/3rd place) if they want custom values.
- 6 Set time windows for their community's timezone.
- 7 Configure placement match settings.
- 8 Click Open Registration when ready.
- 9 Share the tournament URL with their Discord server members.

9. Configuring a Tournament (Full Walkthrough)

A full configuration walkthrough for each Admin tab:

Admin → Season

- 1 Set **Season Name** (e.g. Summer 2025)
- 2 Set **Placement Games** — how many games to classify a player (default 5)
- 3 Set **Swiss Rounds** — rounds of Swiss per division (default 7)
- 4 Set **Top N Playoff Cutoff** — default 8 (Top 8 playoff)
- 5 **Platform Admin Fee** is shown here as read-only — only you (the platform organiser) can set this in `/#/admin`
- 6 Set **Prize Pool Fee** — goes to the host for prizes
- 7 Add the host's **PayPal Email** — required before any paid bracket can open

Admin → Tiers

Each tier = one ELO division with its own Swiss bracket, champion, and prize split. Default: Bronze/Silver/Gold/Diamond.

Edit the ELO ranges to match your community. Example for a 4-division tournament:

Division	ELO Range	Icon
Bronze	0 – 499	Custom emoji
Silver	500 – 799	Custom emoji
Gold	800 – 1099	Custom emoji
Diamond	1100 and up	Custom emoji

Prize splits per division: Each division also has a 1st/2nd/3rd place percentage split (default 60/25/15). These are set per division on the same Tiers page, and the live dollar prize amount for each place updates automatically as more players' payments are confirmed received.

10. Setting Time Windows for Placement Matches

Go to **Admin** → **Time Windows**. Time windows define when the agent is allowed to schedule placement matches. Matches are spread evenly across these windows only.

Each window has: **Day** (Mon–Sun), **Start Hour UTC**, **End Hour UTC**, and a **Label**.

Community Type	Recommended Time Windows (UTC)
USA only	Sat 18:00–23:00 + Sun 18:00–23:00 (ET noon–5pm, PT 10am–3pm)
UK only	Sat 12:00–21:00 + Sun 12:00–21:00 (GMT noon–9pm)
China only	Sat 08:00–15:00 + Sun 08:00–15:00 (CST 4pm–11pm)
USA + UK mix	Sat 16:00–21:00 (ET noon–5pm AND GMT 4pm–9pm at the same time)
EU (CET)	Sat 13:00–21:00 + Sun 13:00–21:00 (CET 2pm–10pm)
No preference	Leave empty — 2-hour gaps, no day restriction

Key rule: All times are UTC. Players always see their match times converted to their own registered timezone automatically.

11. Opening and Closing Registration

Opening registration (Admin → Season → Open Registration):

- 1 The tournament home page now shows a Register button.
- 2 Players can self-register from this moment.
- 3 No admin involvement needed — players fill in all their own details.

Closing registration (Admin → Season → Close & Generate Schedule):

- 1 The agent immediately generates all placement match pairings.
- 2 Pairings are ELO-balanced and rematch-free.
- 3 Time slots are drawn from your configured time windows and spread evenly.
- 4 Every match gets a unique lobby name and password.
- 5 Players log in and see their full schedule instantly — no admin action needed.

This is your most important click. Everything else in the tournament runs automatically once you close registration and generate the schedule.

12. Generating the Placement Schedule

When you close registration, the scheduling algorithm runs automatically:

- 1 Every player is paired with N opponents (N = placement games setting, default 5).
- 2 Pairings minimise ELO difference between opponents.
- 3 No rematches within the same season.
- 4 Players with fewer matches assigned are prioritised in each pairing pass.
- 5 Time slots are drawn from your time windows, spread evenly.
- 6 Each match gets a unique lobby name (e.g. NA-KINGS-R01-THEVvCLAN) and password.

Players see their schedule the moment they log into their portal. They see:

- 1 Opponent name, ELO, and timezone
- 2 Scheduled time in **their own timezone**
- 3 Lobby name, lobby password, and all game settings
- 4 Report result buttons (I Won / I Lost)

13. Opening Division Brackets

- 1 Once enough players are classified (minimum 2 per division), go to **Admin** → **Season**.
- 2 Click **Open Division Brackets**.
- 3 The agent opens all qualifying divisions simultaneously.
- 4 Each division starts in Settings Vote phase.
- 5 Players log in and vote on their preferred map, resources, and speed.
- 6 When voting is done, go to the Divisions tab and click **Lock Settings** for each division.
- 7 Then click **Start Swiss R1** (or use Start All Swiss for all at once).

All divisions run simultaneously. Bronze, Silver, Gold, and Diamond all have their own independent bracket running at the same time.

14. Running Swiss Rounds

Phase	Who Acts	What Happens
Matches play	Players	Both players find lobby info in their portal and play
Results reported	Players	Both report; auto-confirmed if they agree
Round complete	Auto-detected	Next Round button lights up gold
Advance round	Admin — 1 click	Click Next Round in the Bracket tab
After final round	Admin — 1 click	Click Cut to Top 8

Admin involvement per round: **one click**. Everything else is player-driven.

If a round has disputes:

- 1 A red dispute banner appears at the top of the Bracket tab.
- 2 Click Resolve next to the disputed match.
- 3 Review the game recordings and select the correct winner.
- 4 The result is confirmed and the round can advance.

15. Top 8 Playoff

After Swiss completes, the top 8 players by record (Buchholz tiebreaker) advance to seeded single-elimination playoffs.

Seed	Opponent
1st	8th
2nd	7th
3rd	6th
4th	5th

Players self-report playoff results the same way as Swiss matches. A champion banner appears when the Grand Final is confirmed.

16. PayPal Payments & Revenue Tracking

Every player entry fee is split into two separate PayPal payments — one to you (admin fee), one to the tournament host (prize fee). The app tracks each player's payment through three states.

Status	Meaning
■ No Payment Submitted	Player has not yet told the app they've paid
■ Submitted — Awaiting Confirmation	Player clicked "I've Paid Both Fees" — host needs to verify in PayPal
■ Received — Can Play	Host confirmed the money arrived. Player can now enter the tournament bracket.

How a player pays:

- 1 Player logs into their portal. If there's an entry fee, a Payment section appears on their Dashboard.
- 2 Two PayPal buttons are shown: one for the Admin Fee (pays you), one for the Prize Fee (pays the tournament host).
- 3 Each PayPal link is pre-filled with the correct amount and a note containing: the player's email, the tournament name, and their Discord tag.
- 4 After paying both, the player clicks **"I've Paid Both Fees"** — their status becomes Submitted.

How the tournament host confirms:

- 1 Host checks their PayPal account for the incoming prize fee payment, matching by the note (email/tournament/Discord tag).
- 2 Host goes to their tournament's Admin → Payments tab.
- 3 Finds the player and clicks **Confirm Received**.
- 4 Player's status becomes Received — they can now play in the paid bracket.

Important: You (the platform organiser) verify your own admin fee payments separately in your PayPal account using the same tracking note. The tournament host only confirms the prize fee they personally receive — they never see or manage your admin fee.

Your revenue dashboard:

Go to **/#/admin** → **Fees** — this is the only place your admin fee profit is shown, protected behind your master password. It displays your total profit across all tournaments plus a full per-payment history (player, amount, date).

The total **prize pool** is different — it's shown publicly on each tournament's home page, on each division card, and to the tournament host, since it's the prize money everyone is competing for.

Season reset: After a tournament season ends, the host can click "Reset All Payments for Next Season" in Admin → Season. This sets every player back to 'No Payment Submitted' so they can pay again for the next season, while keeping all historical fee records intact for your accounting.

17. Managing Players (Ban, Classify, Password Reset)

Admin → Players — shows all players with status, ELO, and division.

Action	How	Effect
Ban player	Click Ban → confirm	Account suspended, email blocked from re-registering
Unban player	Click Unban	Account restored
Manually classify	Click Classify	Player is placed into their ELO division without completing placements
Reset password	Admin → Passwords → Reset	Player receives a new password you set

18. Dispute Resolution

- 1 The header shows a red dispute count when any match is in conflict.
- 2 Go to the Bracket tab — disputed matches are listed in a red banner at the top.
- 3 Click **Resolve** next to the match.
- 4 A popup shows what each player reported.
- 5 Review the game recordings (both players are required to record).
- 6 Click the correct winner's name.
- 7 The result is confirmed and marked as admin-resolved.

Recording policy: All matches require recordings by default. Make this policy visible in your tournament announcements. A player who disputes a result without a recording will generally lose the dispute.

19. Backup & Restore

Platform-level backup (all tournaments at once):

- 1 Go to `/#/admin` → **Settings**.
- 2 Click **Export Master Backup** — downloads a single JSON file.
- 3 To restore: click **Restore Backup** → select the file → all data restored instantly.

Per-tournament backup:

- 1 Inside any tournament: Admin → Data → Export Backup.
- 2 To restore: Admin → Data → Restore Backup.

Backup schedule: Export master backup before and after each weekend of play. Save to Google Drive or email to yourself.

20. Troubleshooting

Problem	Solution
npm run dev fails	Run npm install first. Delete node_modules and retry.
Tournament URL shows Not Found	Check tournament code in /#/admin. URL must match exactly (case-sensitive).
Data gone after browser refresh	Browser storage was cleared. Restore from backup.
Next Round button greyed out	All matches must be reported before advancing.
Can't open brackets	Need classified players in that division. Check placement progress.
Master password forgotten	Open DevTools (F12) → Application → Local Storage → delete key 'aoe2_v5_superpw' → default 'Wireless' restored.
Tournament admin password forgotten	Log into master admin → Tournaments tab → Change Password next to the tournament.